Table 1.9 Rules for counting significant figures

	Rule	Example
i)	All non-zero digits are significant	1342 has **four** significant figures
ii)	All zeros between two non zero digits are significant	2008 has **four** significant figures
iii)	All zeros to the right of a non-zero digit but to the left of a decimal point are significant.	30700. has **five** significant figures
iv)	a) For the number without a decimal point, the terminal or trailing zero(s) are not significant.	a) 30700 has **three** significant figures
	b) All zeros are significant if they come from a measurement	b) 30700 m has **five** significant figures
v)	If the number is less than 1, the zero (s) on the right of the decimal point but to left of the first non zero digit are not significant.	0.00345 has **three** significant figures
vi)	All zeros to the right of a decimal point and to the right of non-zero digit are significant.	40.00 has **four** significant figures and 0.030400 has **five** significant figures
vii)	The number of significant figures does not depend on the system of units used	1.53 cm, 0.0153 m, 0.0000153 km, all have **three** significant figures

Note: 1 Multiplying or dividing factors, which are neither rounded numbers nor numbers representing measured values, are exact and they have infinite numbers of significant figures as per the situation. For **example,** circumference of circle S = 2πr, Here the factor 2 is exact number. It can be written as 2.0, 2.00 or 2.000 as required.

Note: 2 The power of 10 is irrelevant to the determination of significant figures.

For **example** $x = 5.70\ \text{m} = 5.70 \times 10^2\ \text{cm} = 5.70 \times 10^3\ \text{mm} = 5.70 \times 10^{-3}\ \text{km}$.

In each case the number of significant figures is **three.**

Table 1.10 Rules for Rounding Off

Rule	Example
i) If the digit to be dropped is smaller than 5, then the preceding digit should be left unchanged.	i) 7.32 is rounded off to 7.3 ii) 8.94 is rounded off to 8.9
ii) If the digit to be dropped is greater than 5, then the preceding digit should be increased by 1	i) 17.26 is rounded off to 17.3 ii) 11.89 is rounded off to 11.9
iii) If the digit to be dropped is 5 followed by digits other than zero, then the preceding digit should be raised by 1	i) 7.352, on being rounded off to first decimal becomes 7.4 ii) 18.159 on being rounded off to first decimal, become 18.2
iv) If the digit to be dropped is 5 or 5 followed by zeros, then the preceding digit is not changed if it is even	i) 3.45 is rounded off to 3.4 ii) 8.250 is rounded off to 8.2
v) If the digit to be dropped is 5 or 5 followed by zeros, then the preceding digit is raised by 1 if it is odd	i) 3.35 is rounded off to 3.4 ii) 8.350 is rounded off to 8.4

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